



Multi Touch Technology

Gesture-based Interfaces

To overcome the disadvantages that touch devices have, Google is working on a Gesture Technology called "Continuous Gestures". Presently, it's difficult for a user to select some part of text and search about it or copy and paste it. So, Google's "continuous gestures" recognises touch gesture patterns that are made by the user and acts accordingly. For example, if a user wants to search a line of Text; then he/she can just draw 'g + o' and the search starts. The technology also presents options for the user to choose which search engine to use and maybe also customise gestures for particular actions. This is to be implemented in the future Android phones. While Google is trying to use gesture recognition to improve the already existing touch-based interfaces, companies such as Nintendo, Microsoft and Sony have gone way ahead and made gesture recognition like natural arm movements the way to interact with machines; without any need of touching anything. Through Wii, Nintendo introduced the Wii controller which wirelessly connects itself to the Wii

console and when held in your hand takes in natural human movements as inputs to replicate them on screen. So basically, when you are playing a game which teaches you how to practice Yoga, you actually will have to follow the steps of arm movements with the Wii controller in your palm to complete the game. Nintendo Wii till date is one of the most successful family gaming consoles which is praised for its innovation in controls and User Interaction. Sony also came up with PS Move which is almost the same in terms of functionality, but obviously needs the PlayStation3 console.

Microsoft went a step ahead and removed the burden of holding a controller. With high-end image processing techniques, Microsoft's Kinect can be operated without any controller. In fact you are the controller; so basically, your bone movements are tracked down and replicated on the screen. With Kinect's preciseness, playing a game which teaches Yoga or Dance is not a walk in the park anymore.

Kinect gave rise to a wide range of applications in various fields which includes health and fitness, retail, video games and many more. After Microsoft released the SDK for developing apps on Kinect, people have put it to pretty good use. A non-profit medical research organisation called "West Institute" developed an app named "Reflexion" that helps people through post-surgical physical therapy. A programmer developed a Kinect hack with the help of which his Mom could call an ambulance or other emergency using gestures when no one is

around. Another hack called UbiDisplays which needs a projector also, with the help of which web pages and other digital content such as your Facebook profile are projected onto the walls and users can organise content by a drag-drop interface. Reminds you of the Iron Man movie?

Apps are also being developed for Equipment Training. The Institute for Energy Technology has created virtual environment with equipment that can be interacted with the help of Kinect. So, the employees get to work on this virtual equipment and train themselves, before they actually start working on real equipment.

Retail Companies are also finding a use with Kinect technology; they call it the "Future of Shopping". Cisco is currently working on this technology where the whole store is actually digital, as in all the apparels and accessories are presented to the user through a digital interface. The user can switch between clothes and accessories real fast to check which one's suiting the most. This app helps users in identifying what fits them the best and saves a lot of time, and also increases the chance of buying something. A European Software maker – Extreme Reality is very much inspired by the Kinect Technology, but is aiming to avoid the hardware involved with it – Kinect itself. They're trying to develop a software technology that uses the front facing cameras that almost every modern day laptop and Desktop are equipped with to take gesture inputs from users and translate it onto screen. So, you



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